

Umut Eren Demirci

Game Designer — Systems · Levels · Progression

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Game designer coming to games from twelve years of teaching English and designing courses, with a background in linguistics. I design difficulty curves, progression and systems that players can read at a glance, and I check them with data and playtests: for my mobile games **Brushfall**, **Arcana Siege**, **Cloudhaven Skyport** and **Arcana Match** I built bots that play the real rules to tune pacing and difficulty, and for **The Mouth of Silence** I designed a constructed language as a puzzle system. I work in Unity and Unreal Engine 5 (Blueprints), Excel and design documents.

Projects

Shelf Life · hyper-casual sort puzzle for mobile and web · Unity 6 · play: ueren.itch.io/shelf-life — 2026 · personal project

- Designed a book-sort puzzle with one twist, height: tall volumes fit only on the few tall shelves, so a set with an atlas must finish on one. Later chapters add a returns cart that only gives and locked cases that open when a colour is finished. 40 levels in four chapters.
- Kept a mechanic only if the solver showed it changes the best line: my first two ideas (height per colour, an empty reserved shelf) did nothing and were redesigned, and the generator now rejects any level where the newest mechanic is decoration.
- Bots found the height rule's real job: a careless player dead-ends in 75–98% of games on 9 of 11 height levels, so the game now names a dead end. Documented for a publisher: GDD, flowcharts, level workbook, ad storyboard, CPI test and KPI plan.

Clockwork · hyper-casual puzzle for mobile and web · Unity 6 · play: ueren.itch.io/clockwork — 2026 · personal project

- Designed a ring-rotation puzzle with one twist: cogs that link neighbouring rings at 2:1, and padlocked rings that turn only through a cog. 40 levels in four chapters on a sawtooth, a level map and combo praise, art built on a professional free kit.
- Wrote each level as a spec; a generator lays it out and a breadth-first solver proves every par. Measuring all 40 with bots showed reachable boards track a careless player's moves more closely than par does (r = 0.77 against 0.61).
- Changed it from playtests: one-way cogs read as broken (now two-way at 2:1), and levels 9–10 were a wall (level 10's best line from 6 moves to 4). Documented for a publisher: GDD, flowcharts, level workbook, ad storyboard, CPI test and KPI plan.

Brushfall · hybrid-casual puzzle for mobile and web · Unity 6 · play: ueren.itch.io/brushfall — 2026 · personal project

- Designed a game that chains four genres with one currency per step: a 30-second match-3 charge sets the hero's power, a power climb (eat the smaller monsters) banks paint by colour, and the paint drains famous paintings turned to sand into coloured buckets. Daily painting, weekend Grand Climb with tiers, skins as the paint sink, rewarded revive and refill.
- Balanced with bots at human speed: climbs paid 5–10× what restorations cost, yet weak players ran 9 climbs short on the wrong colours; colour-led drops, chapter prices and restorations that keep their progress cut it to 1–2.
- Synthesized the sound and music and captured a 15-second ad from real play; documented it for a publisher: GDD, flowcharts, live economy workbook, CPI go / kill test and KPI plan. 140 automated tests.

Arcana Siege · match-3 tower defense for mobile · Unity 6 · play: ueren.itch.io/arcana-siege — 2026 · personal project

- Designed a hybrid-casual puzzle defense where every tile colour fires a tower: four towers, seven enemy types, a 1-of-3 upgrade draft with bad-luck protection, 12 sieges in four realms, a daily siege and a rewarded second chance.
- Tuned with bots that play the shipped rules at set speeds, then reworked after a studio playtest: the road now moves with the player's moves, so mashing fell from 87% to 10% and slow thinkers rose from 10% to 50%.
- Set the art and audio direction from a genre study; GDD, flowcharts, balance workbook, ad storyboard, CPI test and KPI plan.

Cloudhaven Skyport · arcade idle management for mobile · Unity 6 · play: ueren.itch.io/cloudhaven-skyport — 2026 · personal project

- Designed an airship-port tycoon in the Airport Master style: a counter chain served by standing at it, 22 build pads and 10 goals per island, staff, Grand Liners, island twists (storms, VIPs) and rewarded-only ads.
- Paced with an economy simulator that plays the shipped rules as three kinds of player: the first pass ended in 15 minutes for everyone, so demand upgrades, slower staff and matching capacity made a 53-minute island where skill counts.
- Directed CC0 art and audio from a genre study; documented it with a GDD, flowcharts, a live economy workbook, a 15-second ad storyboard with CPI go / kill criteria and a KPI plan.

Arcana Match · tarot match-3 for mobile · Unity 6 · play: ueren.itch.io/arcana-match — 2026 · personal project

- Designed the whole game (85 levels on a Fool's Journey map, 11 board shapes, blockers, specials and combos, a 78-card collection, a story I wrote) and a balance simulator of its rules: a spawn-weight sweep lifted level 18 from 33% to 85%.

The Mouth of Silence · narrative puzzle adventure · Unity 6 · play: ueren.itch.io/the-mouth-of-silence — 2026 · personal project

- A playable chapter of my novel: a scholar with no weapon reads *Kha'shul*, a constructed language I designed as the puzzle system (10 words, 5 grammar rules, one rule taught per puzzle, designed near misses instead of fail states).
- Rewrote a star-code puzzle after an outside playtest; wrote every line and produced 343 voiced lines on a zero budget. 16-page GDD, language reference, flowcharts, script sample; 56 rule tests.

The Chronicles of Demise · narrative RPG concept · Unreal Engine 5 — May 2025 – present · personal project

- Prototyped emotion-driven movement in Blueprints (Neutral, Anxious and Determined states set walk speed, braking and screen saturation) for a game adapting my own fantasy novel series.

More design work

Design samples · a level pack, a level teardown, level design, narrative design, feature proposals, game concepts 2026

- A hand-made level pack for Arcana Match: 12 levels, each with an intent, a designed fail point checked against simulated losses, a clear heatmap and logged iterations, tuned to a sawtooth of target win rates.
- A level teardown of Candy Crush Saga's first 105 levels: pacing, teaching and difficulty tags from public level data, two levels rebuilt and simulated, and a redesign of level 46.
- Level design from five shipped games' data: lane rules, a generated 85-level curve, teaching waves, and an open balance problem with a simulated fix.
- Narrative design from the manuscript of my novel: two opposed cosmologies, magic as grammar, three converging strands and a scene study.
- Four live-ops features grounded in each game's data, with A/B tests; three new game concepts scored against a hybrid-casual brief.

Game deconstructions · Raid Rush (Panteon) and Royal Match (Dream Games) 2026

- Broke down each game's core loop, meta, economy and live ops from public data (patch notes, store listings, market estimates, player reviews), and proposed changes, each with a hypothesis, an A/B test design and guardrail metrics.

Tabletop RPG design · D&D 5e modules and world-building Dec 2022 – May 2024

- Wrote and ran adventure modules, adjusting encounters, pacing and rewards from what happened at the table.

Experience

Game Designer · independent, Ankara May 2025 – present

- Designed and released seven playable games on itch.io: **Shelf Life** (hyper-casual sort puzzle), **Brushfall** (hybrid-casual puzzle), **Arcana Siege** (match-3 tower defense), **Cloudhaven Skyport** (arcade idle management), **Arcana Match** (casual match-3), **Clockwork** (hyper-casual puzzle) and **The Mouth of Silence** (narrative puzzle adventure).
- Owned design end to end: core loops, level and difficulty design, balance simulators, playtests and GDDs for all seven; F2P economy, monetisation and ad / KPI plans for the mobile games. Full-time since January 2026.
- I design every game; an AI coding assistant (Claude) writes the code to my specs, and I set the rules and tuning, run the balance simulations and play-test each phase.

Private English Tutor · self-employed, Ankara Jan 2024 – Jan 2026

- Planned one-to-one courses around each learner's level and goals, adjusting pace and difficulty lesson by lesson.

Visa and Education Consultant · TEOL and Bilimevi, Ankara (alongside teaching) 2023 – 2025

- Guided clients through visa and study-abroad applications, from first meeting to decision.

English Teacher and Course Designer · language schools and companies, Ankara 2014 – Dec 2023

- Taught English to groups and corporate clients for nine years, designing courses that introduce one new skill at a time on a rising difficulty curve and adjusting the pace from learners' results.

Skills

Design	Systems and balancing · difficulty curves and level pacing · progression and meta · F2P economy design · live ops · game deconstruction and market analysis · narrative and puzzle design · dialogue writing · playtesting · GDDs and flowcharts
Tools	Unity 6 · C# · Unreal Engine 5 Blueprints · Python · Excel and Google Sheets (formulas, charts, simulation data) · Mermaid / draw.io · Git
Languages	Turkish (native) · English (fluent)

Education

Ankara University · English Language and Literature (2013–2017), then Linguistics (2017–2022) coursework, no degree

Design documents

Shelf Life	One-pager · GDD (6 pages) · Flowcharts · Level design workbook · Ad test and KPI plan
Brushfall	One-pager · GDD (12 pages) · Flowcharts · Balance and economy · Ad test and KPI plan
Arcana Siege	One-pager · GDD (12 pages) · Flowcharts · Balance and economy · Ad test and KPI plan
Cloudhaven Skyport	One-pager · GDD (11 pages) · Flowcharts · Balance and economy · Ad test and KPI plan
Arcana Match	One-pager · GDD (22 pages) · Flowcharts · Balance and economy · Card catalogue
Clockwork	One-pager · GDD (6 pages) · Flowcharts · Level design workbook · Ad test and KPI plan
The Mouth of Silence	One-pager · GDD (16 pages) · Kha'shul language reference · Flowcharts · Script sample
The Chronicles of Demise	Design sample: emotion-driven movement
Design samples	Level pack: The Tower (8 pages) · Level teardown: Candy Crush (8 pages) · Level design (8 pages) · Narrative design (8 pages) · Feature proposals (5 pages) · Game concepts (5 pages)
Deconstructions	Raid Rush (6 pages) · Royal Match (5 pages)
Everything	umuterendemirci.github.io: builds, screenshots and all documents